belly

The Mama Shoot Guide

Short, easy phone videos about your real pregnancy. No acting, no makeup required, no one watching. Just you, talking like you would to a friend.

ABOUT 30 MINUTES · ONE PHONE · ONE WINDOW

Before you hit record

Everything you need is already in the house.

1 Phone, vertical

- Back camera if someone helps you, front camera if alone
- Wipe the lens
- Turn on Do Not Disturb

2 Light

- Face a window, never back to it
- Daytime, overhead lights off
- Soft and warm beats bright

3 Sound

- Smallest, softest room (bedroom is great)
- No fan, TV or dishwasher
- Phone about an arm's length away

4 Framing

- Eyes on the top third of the screen
- Leave a little room above your head
- Prop phone on books at eye level

THE 4 ANGLES WE WANT

Angle	What it looks like	Used for
A · Talk to camera	Chest-up, looking right into the lens, couch or bed behind you	Hooks and stories, the main ads
B · Over the shoulder	Phone in your hand showing the Belly app, filmed from behind your shoulder (needs a helper)	Showing Bella answering a question
C · Bump & hands	Close on your bump, hands resting on it, holding tea, writing in a journal. No face needed	B-roll under voiceover, "week" posts
D · Real life	Making tea, folding tiny clothes, lying on the couch, walking. Phone on a shelf, just live	Background clips, Reels transitions

5 RULES THAT MAKE IT WORK

- **Say the first line within 1 second.** No "hi guys". Start mid-thought.
- **Do 3 takes of each.** Imperfect is good. Laughing, ums and mistakes are fine.
- **Keep each clip 10 to 30 seconds.** Stop and start again rather than one long video.
- **Only say what is true for you.** Your real week, your real cravings, your real worries.
- **Never give medical advice.** "Bella helped me think it through, then I asked my midwife" is perfect.

The shot list

10 clips. Do them in any order. Tick them off as you go.

#	Angle	Clip	Length
1	A	"I'm 5 months pregnant again..." intro (Script 1)	15–20s
2	A	The 3am question story (Script 2)	20–30s
3	B	Type a real question to Bella, let the answer appear on screen	15s
4	B	Use the safety scan on something in your kitchen or bathroom	10s
5	A	"Pregnant again" (Script 3)	20s
6	C	Hands on bump, slow, 3 different spots in the house	3 × 5s
7	D	Making ginger or chamomile tea, start to first sip	15s
8	A	"Things nobody tells you" list (Script 4)	20–30s
9	A	"Why we built Belly" (Script 5)	20–30s
10	A	5 hooks only, one after another (next page)	5 × 3s

EASY FIRST HOOKS

The first 2 seconds decide if people keep watching. Record each one 2 or 3 times, just the line, then stop.

"Nobody warned me about this part of pregnancy."

"It's 3am and I just googled something I shouldn't have."

"Pregnant again and I still have questions."

"Being starving and nauseous at the same time should be illegal."

"Here's what I ask when I can't sleep."

"Five months in. Here's what actually helped."

The scripts

Read them once, then say it your way. Change any word that doesn't sound like you.

Script 1 · Intro (Angle A)

"I’m five months pregnant again, and I still have a hundred questions. So my husband and I built the thing I wished I had the first time. It's called Belly, and it's like having a doula in your pocket. Come along with me."

Script 2 · The 3am question (Angle A, then B)

"It's 3am, I feel something weird, and Google is giving me the worst-case scenario. So now I just ask Bella. She explains it calmly, tells me what's usually normal, and when I should call my midwife. Then I can actually go back to sleep."

Script 3 · Pregnant again (Angle A)

"Everyone says it gets easier after the first time. Nobody says you forget everything. What week does this happen? What was I supposed to avoid? I keep it all in Belly now, week by week, so I'm not starting from zero."

Script 4 · Things nobody tells you (Angle A, count on fingers)

"Things nobody tells you about pregnancy. One: you can be starving and nauseous at the same time. Two: the tiredness is a whole different level. Three: your nose gets stuffy for no reason. Four: you'll cry at a commercial. Tell me yours in the comments."

Script 5 · Why we built Belly (Angle A, honest and slow)

"The first time I was pregnant, I felt alone with my questions. The appointments were short and the forums were scary. So we built Belly: a calm, kind place for the 3am questions, short classes, and other mamas who get it. It's free for seven days if you want to try it."

Honesty note: because you're a co-founder, always say "we built" or "my husband and I made" in videos about Belly. People trust that more, and it keeps us on the right side of advertising rules.

Voice sample for ElevenLabs

Optional, and only if you're comfortable. This lets us make voiceovers in your voice without you recording every one.

HOW TO RECORD IT

- Use the Voice Memos app, phone 20cm from your mouth, in a closet or under a blanket (clothes kill echo)
- Read naturally at your normal speed. Pause between paragraphs. Don't whisper or perform
- Aim for at least 3 to 5 minutes total. More clean audio means a better clone. Read this page twice in different moods (calm, then cheerful)

Hi, I'm so glad you're here. Whether you're trying, expecting, or holding your little one right now, this is a space for you. Take a breath. You're doing better than you think.

This week, your baby is growing every single day. You might feel more tired than usual, or hungrier, or both at once. That's okay. Rest when you can, drink some water, and be gentle with yourself.

Here's something I wish someone had told me: you don't have to have all the answers. It's okay to ask the small questions, the silly ones, the ones that keep you up at night. Write them down. Bring them to your next appointment.

One of my favorite things is a warm cup of ginger tea in the afternoon. I sit by the window, put my feet up, and just breathe for five minutes. No phone, no to-do list. Just me and the baby.

If today was hard, that's okay too. Tomorrow is a new day. You've got a whole circle of mamas who understand exactly how you feel. Good night, mama. Sleep well.

Her voice, her call: ElevenLabs asks the speaker to confirm consent before cloning. We'll only use her clone for scripts she has read and approved, and she can say no or ask us to delete it anytime.

The 30-minute shoot

One relaxed afternoon. Snacks recommended.

Time	Do this
0–5 min	Pick the window spot, prop the phone, film 5 seconds and play it back to check light and sound
5–15 min	Hooks (clip 10), then Scripts 1 and 2. Three takes each, don't watch them yet
15–20 min	Helper films over your shoulder: a Bella question and the safety scan (clips 3, 4)
20–25 min	Bump, hands, and tea b-roll (clips 6, 7). No talking needed
25–30 min	Scripts 3, 4 and 5 if she still has energy. Otherwise stop. Two good clips is a win

AFTER THE SHOOT

- AirDrop or upload everything to one folder. Don't edit, don't delete takes
- Claude cuts them into Reels and ads with captions, and sends them back for her approval before anything goes live
- Nothing goes public that she hasn't seen and said yes to

EVERY WEEK AFTER (2 MINUTES)

One 15-second "week update" with the same framing every time: *"Week 21. Baby is about the size of a ___. This week I'm feeling ___."* This becomes a series people follow all the way to birth.